

The Road Not Taken

Robert Frost (1874–1963)

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

01 Two roads diverged in a yellow wood,
02 And sorry I could not travel both
03 And be one traveler, long I stood
04 And looked down one as far as I could
05 To where it bent in the undergrowth;

06 Then took the other, as just as fair,
07 And having perhaps the better claim,
08 Because it was grassy and wanted wear;
09 Though as for that the passing there
10 Had worn them really about the same,

11 And both that morning equally lay
12 In leaves no step had trodden black.
13 Oh, I kept the first for another day!
14 Yet knowing how way leads on to way,
15 I doubted if I should ever come back.

16 I shall be telling this with a sigh
17 Somewhere ages and ages hence:
18 Two roads diverged in a wood, and I—
19 I took the one less traveled by,
20 And that has made all the difference.

Word help

diverged = separated • undergrowth = plants growing under trees

fair = attractive • wanted wear = needed to be walked on

trodden = stepped on • hence = from now • sigh = a long breath

Text: [Academy of American Poets](#). Public-domain poem, published in 1915; collected in *Mountain Interval* (1916).

Read closely

Answer in English. Support interpretations with words or line numbers from the poem.

1. Where is the speaker at the beginning, and what choice must he make?

2. What prevents the speaker from seeing the whole first road?

3. Copy words that show the two roads are similar.

4. Why does the speaker doubt that he will return?

5. What might the two roads represent? Explain the metaphor.

6. What might the “sigh” suggest? Support your interpretation with another detail.

Before you finish: Check that you have distinguished what the speaker says directly from what you infer.

Connect & interpret

Complete in class if time allows, or continue next lesson.

Background for question 7

Robert Frost and Edward Thomas often walked together in England. Thomas sometimes regretted the route they had chosen and imagined that another route would have been better. Frost partly drew on this habit when writing the poem, teasing his friend gently.

Adapted from David Orr, *Academy of American Poets*.

7. Connect the background about Edward Thomas to one specific detail in the poem. Explain how the connection helps you understand it.

8. Is the speaker satisfied with his choice? Write 60–80 words. Support your view with two details from the poem.

Response check: clear view · two details · explanation of how each detail supports your view